



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 02

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Safe Handling of Sheet Goods (Plywood, MDF, Melamine)

OVERVIEW:

Sheet goods — plywood, MDF, melamine, OSB — are some of the most handled materials in our trade. They are deceptively heavy, awkward, and have edges that cause serious lacerations. Knowing how to move them safely protects your hands, your back, and the workers around you.

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. A full sheet of 3/4-inch plywood weighs approximately 60 pounds. A sheet of 3/4-inch MDF weighs close to 97 pounds. On top of that, sheets are 4 feet wide and 8 feet long, making them almost impossible to control alone. Always use two people for full sheets and always carry them on edge — not flat — so you can see where you are going and reduce the chance of a dropped panel.
2. The edges and corners of sheet goods — especially melamine — are razor sharp. An unprotected hand sliding across a sheet edge can result in a deep laceration that goes straight to the bone. Always wear cut-resistant gloves when moving sheet material. Panel carriers and vacuum lifts are available on many jobs — use them when you have them.
3. MDF deserves special attention every single time you cut it. MDF is bonded with urea-formaldehyde, which is released as fine dust during cutting and sanding. This dust is classified as a probable human carcinogen. Always connect dust collection when cutting MDF. If cutting without collection, wear at minimum an N95 respirator. Never blow MDF dust off yourself with compressed air — it goes
4. When storing sheet goods, stack them flat on a level surface with adequate support every 4 feet to prevent sagging. Never lean full unsupported sheets against a wall — they can and do fall without warning and can cause crush injuries. Keep stacks organized, labeled, and accessible so workers are not digging through piles and handling panels unnecessarily.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

Q1: What panel-handling equipment do we have on this site, and where is it stored?

Q2: Has anyone experienced a laceration from sheet goods? What protection were they wearing at the time?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Use panel carriers or sheet-good carts whenever available
- Wear cut-resistant gloves — edges and corners are razor-sharp
- Never carry full sheets alone in windy or tight conditions
- MDF dust contains formaldehyde — always wear N95 or better
- Stack sheets flat on level surfaces to prevent warping and tip-overs

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 02

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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